

COMPARISON · GRID · STRUCTURE

verdict-grid

Options scored against criteria as a verdict matrix.

Which data platform clears the bar.

Build in-house.

 **Certified**  **Residency**  **Export**

Full control of every axis, and three engineer-quarters from having any of it.

Vendor North.

 **Certified**  **Residency**  **Export**

Certified and in-region, but data export is support-gated, not self-serve.

Vendor West.

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Certified, in-region, and self-serve on every axis. Recommended.



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When NOT to reach for verdict-grid.

Exactly two options. Two options with shared criteria belong in `compare-prose` or `split-compare`. verdict-grid earns its layout at 3+ options.

Missing the rationale line. Every option must end with a marker-less prose line — the verdict for that card. Omit it and the card renders empty below the badges, and the focal last card has nothing to recommend. The rationale is required, not optional.

Badge longer than two words. The text after the marker (`Residency`). A sentence on a badge line is a badge, not a sentence — two words at `Self-serve` breaks the row scan; prose belongs only on the final rationale line.

Cards with different criteria. When each option needs its own criteria list, the comparison fails — `cards-stack` so each card has full prose breathing room instead.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

- `compare-prose` — exactly two options with prose bodies
- `split-compare` — two options with a bottom verdict bar
- `obligation-matrix` — many regimes scored on shared obligations in a table
- `compare-table` — cells are textual values, not state markers
- `checklist` — one set of criteria, not many options against them